THE REDEEMED CHRISTIAN CHURCH OF GOD

Shepherd Connect

Children's Ministry Management Platform

Complete User Guide

Safe. Known. Celebrated.

Platform: Shepherd Connect v1.0

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Covers all user roles:

Admin | **Teacher** | **Attendant** | **Parent**

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1. Introduction & Platform Overview

Shepherd Connect is the full-stack digital management platform for the children's ministry (Children's Church) at RCCG City of David, Victoria Island. It provides a unified system for every person involved in running Sunday services — from senior administrators down to parents dropping off their children.

The platform manages the complete lifecycle of every service: family registration, child check-in and checkout, class assignment, teacher scheduling, real-time attendance tracking, emergency logging, appraisals, reports, and secure delegate pickup.

Core Principles

Safe — Every child has a verified check-in and secure checkout process. Medical and allergy alerts are surfaced at every critical touchpoint.

Known — Each child's class, attendance history, teacher appraisals, and family record are always a click away.

Celebrated — Teachers record appraisals after each service so parents can see how their child engaged with the Word.

User Roles

Role	Access Level
Super Admin	Full system access — user management, approvals, all admin functions
Admin	Command centre, families, children, classes, teachers, emergencies, reports
Teacher	My class view, attendance, appraisals, class change requests, substitutes
Attendant	Check-in kiosk, QR scan, standard and delegate OTP checkout
Parent	My family, my children, pickup delegates, class change requests, feedback

Technology & Access

Shepherd Connect is a web application — accessible on any device with a modern browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge). No app installation is required. The platform is optimised for mobile phones so attendants and parents can use it comfortably on the go.

- Desktop: full sidebar navigation
- Mobile: bottom tab bar for quick access to the most used pages
- All data is synced in real time — no page refresh needed

2. Getting Started — Login & Registration

Logging In

1. **Navigate to the platform URL**
   Open your browser and go to the Shepherd Connect web address provided by your admin.

2. **Select your role tab**
   On the login screen, choose your role (Parent, Teacher, Admin, or Attendant) — this is for display only and does not restrict which account you use.

3. **Enter your credentials**
   Type your email address and password. Click 'Enter the House'.

4. **You are redirected to your home page**
   Admins land on the Dashboard. Teachers land on My Class. Attendants land on Check-In. Parents land on My Family.

> Ø=Ü¡ **Tip** If you have forgotten your password, click 'Forgot your password?' on the login screen to request a reset link.

Registering a New Account

New users register directly from the login page by clicking 'Register here'. The process differs slightly by role.

Parents — 3-step registration

1. **Account details**
   Enter your first name, last name, email address, phone number, and choose a password. Select 'Parent' as your role. Click Next.

2. **Family setup**
   Enter your family name, home address, and emergency contact details. Click Next.

3. **Add your children**
   Click '+ Add Child' for each child. Enter name, date of birth, gender, and any allergy or medical notes. Click 'Finish & Register'. You are logged in immediately.

Admins & Teachers — approval required

Admin and Teacher accounts go through an approval step. After registering, your account is marked 'Pending Approval'. You will not be able to log in until a Super Admin approves your account. You will receive a notification once approved.

> & **Warning** Do not share your login credentials with anyone. Each person should have their own account.

Navigating the Platform

All pages are accessible from the sidebar (desktop) or bottom tab bar (mobile). The navigation adapts to your role — you only see the pages relevant to your access level.

Nav Element	What it does
Bell icon	Notifications — red badge shows unread count
Message icon	Messages — direct messages with staff/parents
Avatar (top right)	My Profile — edit your details and preferences
User Guide	This guide — always accessible at the bottom of the sidebar

3. Admin & Super Admin Guide

Admins have access to every operational module. Super Admins additionally control user accounts and approvals. This section covers every admin function in detail.

3.1 Dashboard — Command Centre

The Dashboard is the admin home screen. It provides a live operational overview of the current service and auto-refreshes every 30 seconds.

Stat Cards

Registered Children: Total children ever registered. Click the card to go to the full Children Directory.

Checked In: Children currently confirmed in class for today's service.

Pending Pickup: Children who have been dropped off but not yet collected by a parent.

Teacher Attendance: Percentage of today's scheduled teachers who confirmed their attendance.

Active Emergencies: Open emergency incidents. The card turns red when any emergency is unresolved.

Dashboard Widgets

- Upcoming Birthdays (30 days) — children with birthdays in the next month. Clickable — opens child profile.
- Absence Alerts — children absent for 2 or more consecutive Sundays, with parent phone numbers for follow-up.
- Attendance Trends — line chart showing weekly check-in numbers over the past several weeks.
- Class Utilization — bar chart of enrolled children vs class capacity for every class.

Ø=Ü¡ Tip dashboard date defaults to today's date. All check-in stats are per service day.

3.2 Families Management

A family record is the foundation of everything. Every child must belong to a family, and every check-in is linked back to a family.

1. **Create a new family**
   Go to Families !' click '+ Add Family'. Fill in: Parent 1 (required), Parent 2 (optional), home address, emergency contact name, and emergency contact phone. Click Save.

2. **Search for a family**
   Use the search bar at the top of the Families page. It searches by family code, parent name, and address in real time as you type.

3. **View a family profile**
   Click 'View' on any family card. The profile shows: both parents' details, all registered children with their classes, and the family code for check-in.

4. **Edit family details**
   Inside the family profile, click 'Edit Family' to update parent details, emergency contact, or address.

5. **Add a second parent**
   Edit the family record and fill in the Parent 2 section with the second parent's user account.

Family Codes

Every family is assigned a unique family code (e.g. FAM-MENS01) automatically when they register. This code is:

- Displayed on the parent's My Family page
- Used at the check-in kiosk to locate the family instantly
- Printed on any export or report relating to that family

> **Ø=Ü¡ Tip:** Encourage parents to memorise or screenshot their family code — it makes check-in significantly faster during busy services.

3.3 Children Directory & Bulk Import

The Children page is the complete registry of every child in the ministry. Admins can add children individually or import many at once using a CSV file.

Adding a Child Manually

1. **Open the Add Child form**
   Go to Children !' click '+ Add Child'.
2. **Select the family**
   Choose the family from the dropdown. The family must exist before you can add a child to it.
3. **Enter child details**
   Fill in: First Name, Last Name, Date of Birth, and Gender (required). Optionally set a Class, upload a Photo, and add Allergy or Medical Notes.
4. **Save**
   Click 'Register Child'. The child is immediately added to the directory and assigned to the selected class.

Bulk Import via CSV

1. **Open the import modal**
   Click 'Import CSV' on the Children page.
2. **Prepare your CSV**
   Required columns: firstName, lastName, dateOfBirth. Optional: gender, allergies, medicalNotes. The dateOfBirth format must be YYYY-MM-DD.
3. **Paste and import**
   Paste your CSV data into the text area (a template is provided). Click 'Import Children'.
4. **Review the results**
   A summary shows how many children were created and any rows that failed, with the reason for each failure.

Filtering the Children List

- Search bar: filters by child first name or last name in real time
- Unassigned Only toggle: shows only children not yet placed in a class — useful after a registration drive

> & **Warning** The 'Unassigned Only' toggle must be OFF to see all children. If the list appears empty, check this toggle is not accidentally enabled.

Child Profile

Click 'View' on any child card to open their full profile. The profile contains:

- Personal details: name, date of birth, age, gender, photo
- Current class assignment
- Medical & allergy alerts (displayed prominently in red)
- Attendance history with dates and check-in/checkout times
- Appraisals written by their teacher
- Family record with parent contact details

3.4 Classes & Assignments

Classes define the age groups and physical rooms. Class Assignments place individual children into specific classes based on their age.

Creating a Class

1. **Go to Classes**
   Navigate to Classes in the sidebar.
2. **Click '+ New Class'**
   Fill in: Class Name (e.g. Nursery, Toddlers, Juniors), Age Range (minimum and maximum age in years), Room Location, and Service Slot (7 AM or 10:30 AM).
3. **Set capacity**
   Enter the maximum number of children the room can hold. This is used for utilization reporting.
4. **Save**
   Click Save. The class is immediately available for child assignments.

Assigning Children to Classes

1. **Go to Assignments**
   Navigate to Assignments in the sidebar.
2. **Click '+ Assign Child'**
   Select the child from the dropdown and then the target class.
3. **Age warning**
   The system warns you if the child's age falls outside the class's age range. You can override this warning if needed.
4. **Confirm**
   Click Assign. The child's current class is updated immediately across all pages.

Reviewing Class Utilization

Go to Reports !' Analytics tab. The 'Class Enrollment vs Capacity' grouped bar chart shows enrolled count (blue) against capacity (gold) for every class. Over-enrolled classes are highlighted in red.

> Ø=Ü¡ Tip Children can only be in one class at a time. Moving a child via a Class Change Request automatically updates their assignment.

3.5 Teachers & Service Allocations

Teachers are staff members registered on the platform. Allocations schedule them to specific classes on specific service dates.

Registering a Teacher

1. **The person registers first**
   The teacher must have a registered user account (Teacher role). Their account must be approved by a Super Admin before proceeding.

2. **Go to Teachers !' + Add Teacher**
   Select the user account from the dropdown. Enter their qualification (e.g. Child Psychology Diploma) and specialisation (e.g. Nursery, Toddlers).

3. **Save**
   The teacher record is created and linked to their user account.

Scheduling Teachers (Allocations)

1. **Go to Allocations !' + Allocate Teacher**
   Select: Teacher, Class, Service Date, and Service Slot (7 AM or 10:30 AM).

2. **Status: Scheduled**
   The allocation is created with status 'Scheduled'. The teacher receives a notification and can confirm or raise a substitute request.

3. **Monitor confirmation**
   The Dashboard Teacher Attendance card shows the % of today's confirmed teachers. Drill into Allocations for the full list.

Monitoring Teacher Presence

Status	Meaning
Scheduled	Allocation created, teacher notified — not yet confirmed
Confirmed	Teacher has confirmed they will attend
Substituted	Original teacher raised a substitute request — cover assigned
Cancelled	Allocation was cancelled by admin

3.6 Attendance Records

Attendance records are created automatically when a child is checked in by an attendant. Admins can view and filter historical attendance data.

Task	Where to do it
View today's attendance	Attendance page !’ filter by today's date
Filter by class	Attendance page !’ use the Class dropdown
Filter by date range	Attendance page !’ set Start and End date
Export to CSV	Reports !’ Exports tab !’ Attendance CSV (with date range)
View absence alerts	Dashboard !’ Absence Alerts widget (2+ missed Sundays)
See a child's full history	Children !’ View child !’ Attendance tab on profile

3.7 Emergencies

The Emergencies module logs any safeguarding incident, medical event, or operational emergency that occurs during a service.

Logging an Emergency

1. **Go to Emergencies !’ + Log Emergency**
   Select the emergency type from the dropdown: Medical Incident, Fire / Evacuation, Missing Child, Safeguarding Concern, or Other.

2. **Fill in the details**
   Write a clear description of what happened. Optionally link a specific child's record. The severity level is set to the appropriate level.

3. **Submit**
   Click 'Log Emergency'. The record is immediately marked Active and the Dashboard emergency counter turns red.

4. **Resolve when addressed**
   Once the situation is handled, click 'Resolve' on the emergency record. Add a resolution note describing the outcome and actions taken.

Exporting the Emergency Log

Go to Reports !’ Exports tab !’ click 'Export Emergency Log (CSV)'. This downloads all emergencies with timestamps, types, descriptions, and resolution notes.

> & **Warning** Emergency records are permanent. They cannot be edited or deleted — only resolved. All actions are captured in the audit log.

3.8 Class Change Requests

Parents or teachers can request that a child moves to a different class. Admins review and action these requests.

1. **Go to Class Changes !’ Pending tab**
   Each pending request shows: the child's name, current class, requested class, who submitted the request, and the reason provided.

2. **Approve**
   Click 'Approve'. Optionally add an admin note. The child is immediately moved to the new class and the requester is notified.

3. **Reject**
   Click 'Reject' and add a note explaining the decision. The child remains in their current class. The requester is notified with the reason.

!9 Note Resolved requests (approved or rejected) are shown on the 'Resolved' tab with the admin note and timestamp.

3.9 Reports

The Reports page has three tabs: Live, Analytics, and Exports.

Live Tab

- Not Picked Up — children still in class at the end of service, with parent phone numbers for immediate contact
- Teacher Ratio — classes below the required teacher-to-child ratio, flagged in red
- Daily Summary — total checked in, still present, and picked up for today's service

Analytics Tab

- Attendance Trends — weekly line chart of total check-ins over time
- Class Enrollment vs Capacity — grouped bar chart showing each class's fill rate
- Feedback Analytics — ratings and sentiment from parent feedback submissions

Exports Tab

- Attendance CSV — choose a date range and download all attendance records
- Emergency Log CSV — full history of all emergencies and their resolutions

3.10 Notifications & Broadcasts

The notification system lets admins send targeted messages to specific roles, or broadcast to all parents of currently checked-in children.

1. **Send a broadcast**
   Go to Notifications !' click 'Broadcast Message'. Write a title and body. Select which roles receive it (Parents, Teachers, Attendants, Admins). Click Send.

2. **Pre-dismissal alert**
   Click 'Send Pre-Dismissal Alert' on the Notifications page. This automatically creates one notification for every parent whose child is currently checked in — ideal 15 minutes before service ends.

3. **Monitor delivery**
   Notification counts appear as red badge numbers on the Bell icon in every recipient's nav bar. Recipients see unread notifications highlighted.

> **Ø=Ü¡Tip** pre-dismissal alerts consistently — parents who receive the alert collect their children faster, reducing post-service congestion.

3.11 User Management — Super Admin Only

The Users page is accessible only to Super Admins. It controls who can access Shepherd Connect and at what permission level.

Approving Pending Accounts

1. **Go to Users !' Pending Approval tab**
   All admin and teacher accounts waiting for approval appear here.

2. **Review the request**
   Check the person's name, email, and role. Verify they are a legitimate member of the ministry team.

3. **Approve or Reject**
   Click 'Approve' to activate the account (they can now log in). Click 'Reject' to deactivate — they will not be able to access the platform.

Managing Existing Users

- Deactivate: removes a user's access without deleting their data — useful when someone leaves the team
- View by role: use the role filter tabs (All, Admin, Teacher, Parent, Attendant) to find users quickly
- Search: use the search bar to find a specific user by name or email

> **!9 Note** Parents and Attendants who self-register are automatically approved — only Admin and Teacher accounts require manual approval.

3.12 Audit Logs

The Audit Log records every significant action in the system with a timestamp, the user who performed it, and what changed. It is the definitive record of all activity on the platform.

What is logged	Examples
Authentication	Login, logout, failed login attempts
Child records	Child created, updated, deleted
Check-in / Checkout	Each check-in and checkout with time and attendant name
Emergency actions	Emergency logged, resolved
User management	Account approved, rejected, deactivated
Class changes	Request submitted, approved, rejected
Broadcasts	Notification sent, pre-dismissal alert triggered

Filtering the Audit Log

- By User: select a specific user from the dropdown to see only their actions
- By Action Type: filter by action category (e.g. checkin, approve_user, emergency)
- By Date Range: set a start and end date to focus on a specific period

& Warning Audit logs are read-only. They cannot be edited, filtered out, or deleted by anyone — including Super Admins.

3.13 Waitlist & Substitute Requests

Waitlist

The Waitlist tracks families waiting for a space in a full class.

- Add to waitlist: Waitlist page !’ + Add to Waitlist !’ select child and class
- Enrol from waitlist: Click 'Enrol' when a space opens in the class
- Remove: Click 'Remove' if the family no longer needs a space

Substitute Requests

Substitute Requests manage teacher cover when a scheduled teacher cannot attend.

- Raise a request: Substitute Requests !’ + New Request !’ select class, date, slot, and reason
- Assign a substitute: Click 'Assign' on a pending request !’ select an available teacher from the list
- Track status: toggle between Pending and Filled tabs to see open and resolved requests

4. Teacher Guide

Teachers use Shepherd Connect to manage their class, record child appraisals, confirm service allocations, and communicate with parents and admin.

4.1 My Class & Schedule

My Class is your home screen. It shows all children assigned to your class with their ages, photos, and allergy alerts.

Viewing Your Class

- Go to My Class in the sidebar to see your full class list
- Each child card shows: name, age, current class, and a red allergy banner if applicable
- Click any child card to open their full profile

& **Warning** Always review allergy and medical notes on child cards before every service. A red 'Medical / Allergy' banner means there is a critical note on file.

Your Service Schedule

Your Teacher Dashboard shows all allocations assigned to you:

- Today's Schedule: classes you are scheduled to serve today, with service time
- Upcoming allocations: future scheduled services

1. **Confirm your attendance**
   Go to Allocations !' find your upcoming allocation !' click 'Confirm'. This notifies admin that you will be present.

2. **If you cannot attend**
   Go to Substitute Requests !' + New Request. Fill in the class, service date, slot, and reason. Your admin is notified and can assign a cover teacher.

Ø=Ü¡ **Tip** Confirm your allocations as early as possible — admin needs accurate counts to ensure enough teachers are present for safety ratios.

4.2 Child Appraisals

After each service, record an appraisal for the children in your class. Appraisals are visible to parents on their My Children page — write them as encouragement to the family.

Creating an Appraisal

1. **Go to Appraisals !' + New Appraisal**
   Select the child (from your class) and the service date.

2. **Rate three areas**
   Each area is rated: Excellent, Good, Fair, or Needs Attention.

Area	What to assess
Participation Level	How actively the child joined in activities, songs, and discussions
Scripture Engagement	How well the child engaged with the Bible lesson and memory verse
Social Interaction	How the child interacted with peers and teachers

3. **Add notes**
   Write a personal note to the parent (e.g. 'Adaeze recited the memory verse perfectly today and helped a younger child with their craft!'). Add any milestone reached.

4. **Save**
   Click 'Save Appraisal'. The parent can see it immediately on their My Children page.

Ø=Ü¡ **Tip** to complete appraisals within 48 hours of the service while your memory is fresh. Specific, positive notes mean much more to parents than generic ones.

4.3 Class Change Requests & Messages

Requesting a Class Change for a Child

1. **Go to Class Changes !' + New Request**
   Select the child and the class you are recommending they move to.

2. **Write a clear reason**
   Explain why the move would benefit the child — age appropriateness, learning pace, social dynamics, etc.

3. **Track the outcome**
   Check the Resolved tab to see if admin approved or rejected your request, and any notes they left.

Messages

Use the Messages page to communicate directly with parents or admin staff.

- New message: Messages !' + New Message !' select recipient !' type and send
- Replies: click on a conversation thread to see the full exchange and reply
- Unread badge: red number on the Messages nav icon — updates every 30 seconds

5. Attendant Guide

Attendants operate the check-in and check-out kiosks. Speed and accuracy are essential — especially during busy service arrivals. Shepherd Connect is optimised for fast kiosk operation.

5.1 Standard Check-In

1. **Open Check In**
   Navigate to Check In in the sidebar (or tap Check In in the bottom tab bar on mobile).
2. **Find the family**
   Type the child's name, parent name, or family code into the search bar. Results appear instantly.
3. **Expand the family**
   Click the family card to reveal all children in the family.
4. **Check in the child**
   Click 'Check In' next to the correct child's name.
5. **Review the confirmation dialog**
   The dialog shows: child's name, assigned class, allergy alerts (RED — must be acknowledged), and the service slot selector.
6. **Select service slot and confirm**
   Choose '7:00 AM Service' or '10:30 AM Service'. Click 'Confirm Check In'. The child's status changes to Checked In.

& **Warning** ALWAYS read any allergy or medical alert shown on the confirmation screen. Never check in a child without acknowledging a medical alert. Inform the class teacher before the child enters.

Ø=Ü¡ **Tip** Family code is the fastest lookup method. Ask the parent: 'Do you have your family code?' — it is on their My Family page.

5.2 QR Code Check-In

1. **Open the QR scanner**
   On the Check In page, click the QR Code tab (or the QR icon in the mobile bottom bar). Allow camera access when prompted.
2. **Scan the parent's QR code**
   Ask the parent to show their QR code from the Shepherd Connect app. Hold the camera steady — the code is detected automatically.
3. **Complete check-in**
   The family is looked up and the check-in screen opens automatically. Proceed from Step 5 of the Standard Check-In process.

Ø=Ü¡ **Tip** QR check-in is ideal for parents who attend regularly. It removes the need to type and speeds up the queue significantly.

5.3 Check-Out — Parent Pickup

When a parent collects their child at the end of the service, the checkout marks the child as 'Picked Up' and removes them from the present list.

1. **Go to Check Out !' Standard Pickup tab**
   Navigate to Check Out in the sidebar.
2. **Search for the child**
   Type the child's or parent's name into the search bar.
3. **Verify the collecting adult**
   Confirm the adult matches the parent on record. If a different person is collecting, switch to the Delegate OTP tab.
4. **Complete checkout**
   Click 'Check Out' next to the child. A confirmation is shown and the child's status changes to Picked Up.

!9 Note A child can only be checked out if they are currently checked in. Children with status 'Picked Up' or 'Not Checked In' will not appear on the checkout list.

5.4 Check-Out — Delegate OTP

When someone other than the registered parent collects a child, they must present a one-time password (OTP) that was issued by the parent through their app.

1. **Switch to the Delegate OTP tab**
   On the Check Out page, click the 'Delegate OTP Checkout' tab.
2. **Enter the 6-digit OTP**
   Ask the collecting adult for their 6-digit OTP. The parent generates this in advance from their Pickup Delegates page. Type the code into the OTP field.
3. **Click 'Verify & Check Out'**
   The system validates the OTP and displays the child's name and the delegate's registered name.
4. **Confirm the identity**
   Visually confirm the collecting adult matches the delegate name shown on screen. Click 'Complete Checkout'.
5. **OTP is invalidated**
   The OTP is single-use. Once used, it cannot be used again. The checkout is recorded with the delegate's name.

& Warning NEVER release a child to a delegate without a valid OTP confirmation from the system. If the OTP fails or is expired, the parent must generate a new one. Do not override this process under any circumstances — it exists to protect the child.

!9 Note OTPs are valid for 24 hours from when the parent created them. Delegates should receive their OTP from the parent before arriving at church.

OTP Troubleshooting

Situation	Action
OTP says 'Invalid'	The code was typed incorrectly. Ask the delegate to read it again carefully.
OTP says 'Expired'	The 24-hour validity has passed. The parent must generate a new code.
OTP says 'Already Used'	The code was already used in a previous checkout. Contact admin.
Delegate has no OTP	Do not release the child. Contact the parent directly to verify and generate a new OTP.

6. Parent Guide

Shepherd Connect gives parents full visibility into their children's ministry experience — from registration through to appraisals and pickup. Everything is managed from your phone or computer.

6.1 Registration Walkthrough

New parents register in three steps from the login page. The whole process takes about 3–5 minutes.

1. **Go to the login page and click 'Register here'**
   Select 'Parent' as your role on the tab bar. Click 'Register here' below the login form.

2. **Step 1 — Your account details**
   Fill in: First Name, Last Name, Email Address, Phone Number, and Password. Your email will be your login username. Click Next.

3. **Step 2 — Your family details**
   Fill in: Family Name (e.g. 'The Mensah Family'), Home Address, Emergency Contact Name, and Emergency Contact Phone. This contact is used if we cannot reach you during a service. Click Next.

4. **Step 3 — Add your children**
   Click '+ Add Child' for each child. For each child enter: First Name, Last Name, Date of Birth, Gender. Optionally add Allergies (e.g. 'Peanuts, Dairy') and Medical Notes (e.g. 'Has mild asthma — inhaler in bag'). Click 'Finish & Register'.

5. **You're in!**
   You are logged in automatically and taken to your My Family page. Your family code is displayed at the top.

> **Ø=Ü¡Tip:** You can add more children after registration — just use the '+ Add Child' button on your My Family page at any time.

6.2 My Family & My Children

My Family Page

My Family is your home screen. It shows your complete family profile and all your registered children.

What you see	What it means / what to do
Family Code (e.g. FAM-MENS01)	Show this to the attendant at check-in for instant lookup — no searching needed
Parent 1 & Parent 2	The adults linked to this family — edit via 'Edit Family' if details change
Emergency Contact	Shown to staff if we cannot reach you — keep this updated
Children cards	Each registered child with their current class — click to manage
+ Add Child button	Register an additional child to your family

My Children Page

My Children shows a more detailed view of each child including their attendance history and teacher appraisals.

- Expand a child's card to see their attendance history — dates, check-in time, checkout time, and status
- Read teacher appraisals — star ratings for Participation, Scripture Engagement, and Social Interaction, plus personal notes from the teacher
- Submit a class change request directly from this page if you feel your child would benefit from a different class

Ø=Ü¡ Tip Teacher appraisals are usually updated within 48 hours after each service. Check My Children on Monday or Tuesday to see how your child got on.

6.3 Pickup Delegates & OTP

If someone other than yourself will collect your child — a grandparent, aunt, uncle, family friend — you must add them as a pickup delegate and share their one-time password (OTP) before they arrive at church.

Adding a Pickup Delegate

1. **Go to Pickup Delegates**
   Navigate to Pickup Delegates in your sidebar or tap the Delegates icon.
2. **Click '+ Add Delegate'**
   Fill in: Delegate's Full Name, Phone Number, and Relationship to your child (e.g. Grandmother, Uncle, Family Friend).
3. **Save and copy the OTP**
   After saving, a 6-digit OTP is displayed ONCE. Copy it immediately using the copy button. Share it with your delegate via WhatsApp or phone call.
4. **The delegate presents the OTP at church**
   When collecting your child, the delegate gives the 6-digit code to the attendant at the exit. The system verifies it and releases your child.

& Warning The OTP is shown ONLY ONCE when the delegate is created. If you did not copy it, you must delete the delegate and add them again to generate a new code. OTPs expire after 24 hours and can only be used once.

Managing Delegates

- You can have multiple delegates at the same time — each gets their own unique OTP
- Delete a delegate to revoke their access immediately — their OTP becomes invalid
- If a delegate's OTP expires before use, delete and re-add them to get a new code

!9 Note Your delegate does not need a Shepherd Connect account. They only need the 6-digit OTP code you share with them.

6.4 Feedback, Notifications & Messages

Submitting Feedback

Use the Feedback page to share your experience of the children's ministry with the admin team.

1. **Go to Feedback !' + Submit Feedback**
   Rate the service out of 5 stars.

2. **Select a category**
   Choose from: General, Safety & Security, Curriculum & Teaching, Staff Attitude, or Facilities.

3. **Write your comments**
   Be as specific as possible — detailed feedback helps the team make real improvements. Click Submit.

!9 Note Feedback is visible to church admins only — not to other parents. Your name is recorded for possible follow-up if you raise a concern.

Notifications

Admins send you important updates through the notification system. A red badge on the Bell icon tells you how many unread notifications you have.

Notification type	When you receive it
Service announcements	General news from the children's ministry admin
Pre-dismissal alert	Sent ~15 minutes before service ends — time to come to the exit
Class change approved/rejected	When your class change request is actioned by admin
New appraisal	When your teacher submits an appraisal for your child

Messages

The Messages page lets you send direct messages to the ministry team — teachers, admins, or other designated staff.

- New message: Messages !' + New Message !' select recipient !' type and send
- Unread replies: shown with a bold thread and a badge number on the Messages nav icon
- Keep messages professional and relevant to your child's ministry experience

7. Demo Accounts Reference

The following accounts are available in the platform for testing and demonstration purposes. These are pre-configured with seed data to demonstrate all features.

Role	Email Address	Password	Notes
Super Admin	superadmin@shepherd.com	admin123	Full access including user approvals
Admin	admin@shepherd.com	admin123	Full admin — no user management
Teacher	teacher1@shepherd.com	teacher123	Linked to a teacher record and class
Attendant	attendant@shepherd.com	attend123	Check-in and checkout kiosks only
Parent	parent1@shepherd.com	parent123	Has 2 children and 1 delegate

& Warning These demo accounts are for testing only. In a live production environment, all staff must register their own personal accounts. Demo passwords must be changed before the platform goes live with real families.

8. Support & Troubleshooting

Common Issues

Issue	Resolution
I cannot log in	Check your email and password. If your account is Admin or Teacher, it may be pending approval — contact your Super Admin.
Children page shows empty	Ensure the 'Unassigned Only' toggle is switched OFF. Also confirm you have children registered in your family.
OTP says invalid or expired	OTPs expire after 24 hours. The parent must delete the delegate and re-add them to generate a new code.
I don't see my notification	Check the Notifications page directly — the bell badge may not update instantly. Refresh the page if needed.
My class list is empty (teacher)	Your admin may not have allocated you to a class yet. Check the Allocations page or contact your admin.
CSV import failed	Ensure dateOfBirth is in YYYY-MM-DD format (e.g. 2018-04-12). All required columns must be present.
I registered but can't log in	If you registered as Admin or Teacher, you are pending approval. Contact your Super Admin to approve your account.

Getting Help

1. **Check the User Guide on the platform**
   The User Guide page is always accessible from the bottom of the sidebar — navigate to User Guide for role-specific instructions.

2 **Send a message to your admin**
Use the Messages page to send a direct message to an admin. Include your name and a clear description of the issue.

3 **During a service — speak to an attendant**
For urgent check-in or checkout issues during a service, approach the attendant at the check-in desk directly.